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■ *District 13-C*

Seeley claims title over Drummond

By CLAYTON JONES
of the Missoulian

Like a trustworthy car running on empty, the Seeley-Swan Blackhawks had just enough left in the tank to get home.

Seeley, which watched a 39-26 lead disintegrate after intermission, rallied in the final period to claim the District 13-C basketball championship with a 56-52 win over Drummond Saturday at Missoula Hellgate.

Both Seeley-Swan and Drummond will advance to next week's Western C Divisional in Helena. Victor suffocated Valley Christian 54-46 in the consolation game, but lost out on a chance to challenge for the second 13-C divisional tournament berth when Seeley beat Drummond.

■ **Seeley-Swan 65, Drummond 52:** Seeley's free-flowing offense poured it on the Trojans in the first half, building a 35-18 lead and looking invincible. The Blackhawks dominated every facet of the game and seemed in complete control.

But Drummond, the No. 1 seed, refused to go down gently and when Seeley came out flat to start the second half, the Trojans pounced on them behind the play of guards Robin Piippo and Ryan Bradshaw.

The pair combined for Seeley's first 13 points of the third period, and eventually led the Trojans to a 50-49 lead on a hoop by Piippo with 5:27 left in the game.

"The first half was just too easy," said Seeley-Swan coach Kim Haines. "Both teams played awfully hard and both were worn out by the end of the game. I asked them during the timeout if they wanted to come back up here Monday and play Victor (in a challenge game). Maybe that did it. We showed a lot of gumption to come back and win. It is the sign of a good ball club."

With their usual adept shooting touch gone, the Blackhawks won the game the old fashioned way — by holding the Trojans to just two points over the final five minutes of the game and making just enough free throws to win.

A follow-up shot by Pat Morin put Seeley ahead 52-50, then Morin and Matt Schnieter each hit two big free throws in the final 1:30 to give the Blackhawks the final four-point margin of victory.

Morin and Schnietger each had 15 points to lead Seeley, while Jesse Boone added 13.

Piippo scored 18 and Bradshaw 16 for Drummond, which didn't have quite enough scoring balance to win the game.

■ **Victor 54, Valley Christian 46:** The key to the Pirates second win of the tournament over the Eagles was pace. Victor likes it slow and that was the way the game was played throughout most of this foul-plagued game.

The score was knotted at 34 after three periods, but the Pirates made 12-16 free throws in the last quarter to win going away.

Victor was 24-of-35 from the line for the game, compared to 12-of-20 for Valley Christian.

Guard Travis Ogilivie led Victor with 17 points, while Valley Christian, normally an uptempo team, was frustrated by the slow pace of the game, and could put no one in double figures.

Consolation game

Valley Christian	8	15	11	12	– 46
Victor	11	14	9	20	– 54

VALLEY CHRISTIAN (7-14) – Marty Gibbons 3-13 3-5 9, Bryce Miller 3-4 1-2 7, Adam McEldurry 2-7 2-2 6, Dan Eisen 1-3 0-0 2, Jeremy Betty 4-14 0-0 8, Charlie Duval 2-7 2-3 6, Britton Boedecker 1-4 4-8 6, Ryan DeGroot 1-1 0-0 2. Totals 17-53 12-20 46

VICTOR (10-12) – Travis Ogilvie 3-8 11-16 17, T.J. Gerhard 4-9 3-6 11, Bobby Schaefer 0-4 2-2 2, Nick Gerhard 4-5 3-3 11, Beau Doberstein 1-6 4-6 6, T. J. Rodriguez 3-6 1-2 7. Totals 15-38 24-35 54.

3-point goals — Valley Christian 0, Victor 0. Total fouls — Valley Christian 27, Victor 23. Fouled out — T.J. Gerhard, Nick Gerhard, Betty. Rebounds — Valley Christian 38 (Gibbons 6), Victor 32 (T.J. Gerhard 8). Turnovers — Valley Christian 21, Victor 22.

Championship game

Seeley-Swan	23	19	9	8	– 56
Drummond	14	12	17	9	– 52

SEELEY-SWAN (16-5) – Pat Morin 5-6 3-4 15, Abe Kats 2-6 2-2 6, Jesse Boone 5-16 3-8 13, Matt Schnieter 4-11 6-7 15, Mike Larson 2-8 0-0 4, Leif Ibsen 0-0 2-2 2, James Webb 0-0 1-2 1. Totals 18-47 17-25 56

DRUMMOND (15-5) – Robin Piippo 6-18 4-6 18, Ryan Bradshaw 5-15 2-2 16, Brett Mackay 1-5 0-0 2, Tyson Lind 1-3 2-2 4, Jeff Buck 5-13 0-1 10, Michael Nelson 1-2 0-0 2. Totals 19-56 8-11 52.

3-point goals — Seeley-Swan 3 (Morin 2, Schnieter 1), Drummond 6 (Bradshaw 4, Piippo 2). Total fouls — Seeley-Swan 13, Drummond 18. Fouled out — Piippo. Rebounds — Seeley-Swan 36 (Schnieter 8, Larson 8), Drummond 29 (Buck 7). Turnovers — Seeley-Swan 15, Drummond 13.

13-C pairings

DISTRICT 13-C
At Missoula Hellgate
(Two advance)
Wednesday

Drummond, bye
Victor 58, Valley Christian 54
Seeley-Swan 72, Lincoln 50
Alberton 74, Philipsburg 59

Thursday

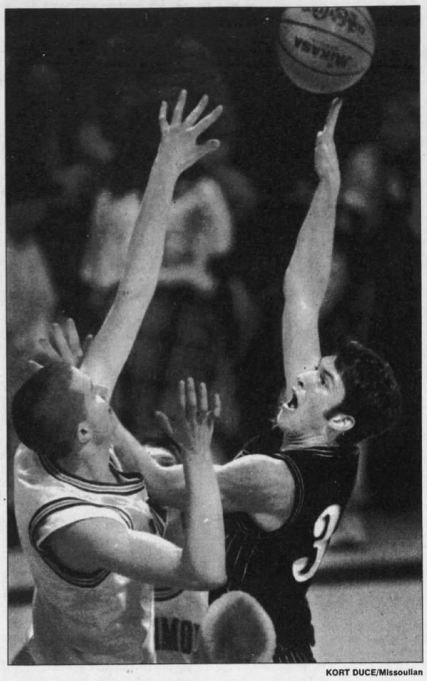
Philipsburg 77, Lincoln 61, loser out
Drummond 43, Victor 40, semifinal
Seeley-Swan 93 Alberton 57, semifinal

Friday

Victor 63, Philipsburg 45, loser out
Valley Christian 76, Alberton 56, loser out

Saturday

Victor 54, Valley Christian 46, consolation
Seeley-Swan 56, Drummond 52, championship



KORT DUCE/Missoulian

Seeley Lake's Jesse Boone shoots the ball over Drummond's Jeff Buck during the Blackhawks' 56-52 victory over the Trojans Saturday.

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